Backbone Detectives · Knowledge Organiser

Learning goal: I can use inside body clues to sort tricky animals and explain my choice.

Today I Can

I can check inside clues instead of guessing from legs or wings.

I can sort eight animals into backbone and no backbone.

I can explain my choice using because.

Must-Know Words

vertebrate: an animal with a backbone inside

invertebrate: an animal with no backbone inside

evidence: a body clue that proves your choice

exoskeleton: a hard case on the outside of a body

Core Science Steps

Look at the snake x-ray. It has no legs, yet a long spine runs down its back.

That inside bone row proves the snake is a vertebrate.

Look at the lobster. It is large with legs, but its hard shell is outside with no spine inside.

Keep the Science Clear

Compare wings or legs with the inside x-ray. The inside bone row is the only proof.

Outside photos alone can hide bones. Always ask for

the inside structure clue.